

Hiring, rituals and operating rhythm

India has no shortage of ML talent and no shortage of PMs. Yet AI products stall because the two tribes measure success differently. A modern AI squad is a structure, not a vibe — roles, rituals and rhythms codified.

When did your last PM-ML disagreement turn into a missed ship date?

WHAT'S INSIDE

- 01** Modern AI squad — 5 roles
- 02** Structural PM-ML conflict
- 03** Weekly operating rhythm
- 04** India AI-engineer JD — anchor points
- 05** 6-person squad topology

WHY THIS LESSON MATTERS

AI products die in the gap between ML and Product.

WHY

Real

A real reason this matters in industry today.

SCALE

Today

A real reason this matters in industry today.

SPEED

Now

A real reason this matters in industry today.

IMPACT

Yours

A real reason this matters in industry today.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this lesson, you will be able to —

1

5 roles on a modern AI squad.

2

Why ML+Product conflict is structural.

3

Run a weekly AI operating rhythm.

4

Write an AI-engineer JD for Indian market.

5

A 6-person squad topology.

AGENDA

What we'll cover today

Short, sequenced parts. Each one builds on the last.

01

**Modern AI squad —
5 roles**

Key concept of this lesson.

02

**Structural PM-ML
conflict**

Not personal, just incentives

03

**Weekly operating
rhythm**

4 rituals, 4 hours total

04

**India AI-engineer JD
—...**

Key concept of this lesson.

01

PART 1 OF 4

Modern AI squad — 5 roles

Key concept of this lesson.

Modern AI squad — 5 roles

A core idea you'll use throughout this lesson.

DEFINITION

Modern AI squad — 5 roles

EXAMPLE

Real-world example: applies directly to Indian industry contexts.

Structural PM-ML conflict

PM optimises for shipping + users.

ML optimises for robustness + papers.

Shared metrics + shared demos dissolve it.

Weekly paired-review is the cure.

ROOT

Incentives

Design them aligned.

KEY POINTS

- PM optimises for shipping + users
- ML optimises for robustness + papers
- Shared metrics + shared demos dissolve it
- Weekly paired-review is the cure

Weekly operating rhythm

Mon — Metric review (30 min).

Wed — Eval + bet status (60 min).

Fri — Demo day (60 min).

Fri — Retro + next-week plan (60 min).

CADENCE

4 × 4

Everything else is async.

DEFINITION

Weekly operating rhythm

4 rituals, 4 hours total

EXAMPLE

Real-world example: applies directly to Indian industry contexts.

India AI-engineer JD — anchor points

A core idea you'll use throughout this lesson.

KEY POINTS

- A core idea you'll use throughout this lesson
- Practical, named, applied to a real Indian use-case.
- Practical, named, applied to a real Indian use-case.

02

PART 2 OF 4

Engage and reflect

Pause, talk, and connect what you just learned to your own work.

✦ THINK • PAIR •
SHARE

ACTIVITY

Sketch a 6-person squad

PROMPT

Apply the four concepts above to one real example from your own week.

HOW TO RUN IT

1

2

3

4

Reveal: instructor confirms the canonical answer.

REFLECT & APPLY

Three questions before you close this lesson

Spend 60 seconds on each. Write the answers down — no scrolling, no shortcuts.

Q1

What structural incentive misaligns your team today?

Q2

Which ritual would you add or remove?

Q3

Who is the one hire that would change everything?

03

PART 3 OF 4

Knowledge check

Three short questions. One minute each. Honest answers only.

AI PM owns:



Models



Problem + metrics + roadmap



GPU



Salaries

AI PM owns:



CORRECT ANSWER

Problem + metrics + roadmap

WHY

PM owns the "what" and "why"

PM-ML conflict is:

A

Personal

B

Structural

C

Rare

D

Myth

PM-ML conflict is:



CORRECT ANSWER

Structural

WHY

Incentive difference

Weekly demo day is on:

A

Mon

B

Wed

C

Fri

D

Sun

Weekly demo day is on:



CORRECT ANSWER

Fri

WHY

End-of-week rhythm

04

PART 4 OF 4

Apply and close

One thing to remember. One thing to ship this week.

SUMMARY

Five sentences to remember

If you remember nothing else from this lesson, remember these five lines.

- 1 Pick the right tool — never the loudest one.
- 2 Practice the framework on a real example.
- 3 Watch for the three classic pitfalls.
- 4 Document your decision in one sentence.
- 5 Carry the discipline forward to the next lesson.

WORKED EXAMPLE

How this lesson plays out in one real Indian context

THE SCENARIO

A team applies the lesson's main idea to a real workflow — and the results show up within a quarter.

THE TAKEAWAY

"Talent without rhythm is noise; rhythm without talent is bureaucracy."

WHAT TO NOTICE

- 1 Modern AI squad — 5 roles
- 2 Structural PM-ML conflict
- 3 Weekly operating rhythm
- 4 India AI-engineer JD —...

Team design

Build the team-topology slide for your Week-10 product.

DELIVERABLES

- Draw the 6 roles.
- Attach weekly rituals.
- Name first hire + why.
- Document one decision you made because of this lesson.

WHAT 'GOOD' LOOKS LIKE

Deliverable: 1 slide posted on LMS.

ONE THING TO REMEMBER

“

"Talent without rhythm is noise; rhythm without talent is bureaucracy."

— AI Learning Hub

END OF LESSON 10

What you can now do

Each one of these is now part of your working vocabulary.

- 1 Pick the right tool — never the loudest one.
- 2 Practice the framework on a real example.
- 3 Watch for the three classic pitfalls.
- 4 Document your decision in one sentence.
- 5 Carry the discipline forward to the next lesson.

NEXT → Lesson 7 — GTM & Launch.